

Math 105: Calculus with Algebra
Instructor: David Zureick-Brown (“DZB”)

Worksheet archive

Gradescope code: **B5J8EN**

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Gradescope Instructions for submitting work in Math 105

You will be using the online Gradescope program to submit your homework and exams. These instructions tell you how to sign up initially, and how to submit your written work.

Signing up for Gradescope the first time.

If you haven't used Gradescope for an **Amherst College** course before:

- Go to <http://www.gradescope.com>, click on "Sign up for free" (which may auto-scroll you to the bottom of the page), and select Sign up as [a] "Student".
- In the signup box:
 - Use the course entry code **B5J8EN**
 - Use your full name
 - Use your **Amherst College email** address. Or, if you are a Five-College student, use your email address from your own school.
 - Leave the "Student ID" entry blank.
- You will probably get an email asking to set a password for your account, so check your **amherst.edu** email inbox. (Or your email inbox through your own school, for Five-College students.)

Adding Math 105 to Gradescope.

If you **have** used Gradescope for an Amherst course before, and so you already have an account through your **amherst.edu** email, you still need to add Math 105, so:

- Go to <http://www.gradescope.com> and log in.
- Go to your Account Dashboard (click the Gradescope logo at upper left), and click "Add Course" at bottom right.
- Use the course code **B5J8EN**

(submission instructions on next page)

Submitting written work

First write it out on paper as you would normally. Then **scan it** to create a PDF. One method for scanning is the smartphone app **DropBox**. It makes nice clear scans, and it saves them directly into a folder so that you can have all your assignments in one place. **CamScanner** is another free scanning App, and there are others, too. **Gradescope** now has its own scanning app. You can also use a printer/scanner if you prefer.

Please be kind to our dear graders and make sure your submission is legible !

In particular, please leave some spacing between separate problems.

If you have a tablet computer, you may write your work there (instead of on paper) and save it as a PDF.

Some of you may know the math formatting package LaTeX and may want to use it in Math 105. That's fine, too; if so, you may write up your work in LaTeX and save the resulting PDF.

In short, any method is fine as long as it creates a legible PDF file and NOT a photo.

For example, if you use the DropBox app, then in your created *Math 105 Homework* Dropbox folder, you can select create (+) at the bottom of the screen and click the *Scan Document* option. Snap a shot of the first page of your homework, and then click [+] to snap shots of any subsequent pages. Do **not** use the *Take Photo* option.

After you have scanned/saved your work as a PDF, submit it on Gradescope as follows:

- Go to <http://www.gradescope.com> and log in.
- Select the course “Math 105, Fall 2026” and the appropriate assignment.
- Select “submit pdf” to submit your work in PDF format. Browse to find your PDF and upload.
- Now it is time to **tag** your problems. **This is an important step**, where you are telling Gradescope which problems are on which page(s).

For each problem, select the pages of your submission where your written solution appears.

I think the easiest thing to do is to click on the page of **your** homework upload where you wrote the given problem, and then click on the assigned problem listed. Repeat for each problem.

You must tag the problems or else you will not get credit for your work.

Gradescope will give you a warning when you go to submit your assignment if you have not selected the pages correctly. If you tag a problem incorrectly, you can fix it by clicking “More” and “Reselect Pages”.

- Click Save or Submit.

After your assignment is graded, you will be able to see your score on the written problems, along with comments, on Gradescope. You should receive an email notifying you when each homework set is graded.

Math 105, Fall 2026, Lab Worksheet 1

1. Which of the following are true and which are false? If it is false, then explain briefly why.

(a) $\frac{0}{1} = 0$

(b) $\frac{1}{0} = 0$

(c) $\frac{0}{0} = 0$

2. Simplify each of the following expressions. Show your work.

(a) $\frac{\left(\frac{p}{q}\right)}{\left(\frac{s}{t}\right)}$

(b) $\frac{1}{\left(\frac{s}{t}\right)}$

(c) $\frac{\left(\frac{p}{q}\right)}{s}$

(d) $\frac{p}{\left(\frac{s}{t}\right)}$

3. Write as a single fraction:

$$1 + \frac{1}{1 + \frac{1}{a}}$$

Hint: start with the fraction in the denominator.

4. Write as a single fraction:

$$\frac{\frac{1}{1-a} - \frac{1}{1-b}}{a-b}$$

5. Solve each of the following equations (if possible):

(a) $x^2 - 4x - 21 = 0$

(b) $x^2 - x + 7 = 0$

(c) $x^2 + 2x - 4 = 0$

6. YES or NO: Does $\sqrt{x^2 + 4} = x + 2$? Why or why not?

Recall: The Absolute Value Function $f(x) = |x|$ is a *piecewise defined function* defined by

$$f(x) = |x| = \begin{cases} x & \text{if } x \geq 0 \\ -x & \text{if } x < 0 \end{cases}$$

7. Express $|2x + 1|$ using piecewise notation. In other words, fill in the blanks:

$$|2x + 1| = \begin{cases} \underline{\hspace{2cm}} & \text{if } x \geq \underline{\hspace{2cm}}, \\ \underline{\hspace{2cm}} & \text{if } x < \underline{\hspace{2cm}}. \end{cases}$$

8. Solve each inequality for x (i.e. find all x so that the inequality is true). Express your answer in terms of intervals and illustrate the solution set on the real number line. (Hint for part b: Think about distance between x and 5!)

(a) $\left| \frac{x}{3} - 1 \right| - 7 \geq -5$

(b) $0 < |x - 5| < \frac{1}{2}$

(c) $|x - 5|(2 - x) > 0$

9. Evaluate the absolute value in each of the following:

(a) $|4 - x|$ if $x < 4$

(b) $|4 - x|$ if $x > 4$

By “evaluate”, we mean: “what are all of the possible values of $|4 - x|$?”

10. Solve the following equations for x :

(a) $|3x + 1| = 5$

(b) $\left| \frac{2x - 1}{x + 1} \right| = 3$

Each person turn in your own solutions, using Gradescope, by 11:55pm tonight (Thursday).

Math 105, Fall 2026, Lab Worksheet 1

1. Which of the following are true and which are false?

(a) **True.**

$$\frac{0}{1} = 0.$$

(b) **False.** The expression $\frac{1}{0}$ is undefined.

(c) **False.** The expression $\frac{0}{0}$ is undefined.

2. Simplify each of the following expressions.

(a)

$$\frac{\frac{p}{q}}{\frac{s}{t}} = \frac{p}{q} \cdot \frac{t}{s} = \boxed{\frac{pt}{qs}}.$$

(b)

$$\frac{1}{\frac{s}{t}} = \boxed{\frac{t}{s}}.$$

(c)

$$\frac{\frac{p}{q}}{s} = \frac{p}{q} \cdot \frac{1}{s} = \boxed{\frac{p}{qs}}.$$

(d)

$$\frac{p}{\frac{s}{t}} = p \cdot \frac{t}{s} = \boxed{\frac{pt}{s}}.$$

3. Write as a single fraction:

$$1 + \frac{1}{1 + \frac{1}{a}}.$$

First,

$$1 + \frac{1}{a} = \frac{a+1}{a}.$$

Thus

$$1 + \frac{1}{\frac{a+1}{a}} = 1 + \frac{a}{a+1} = \boxed{\frac{2a+1}{a+1}}.$$

4. Write as a single fraction:

$$\frac{\frac{1}{1-a} - \frac{1}{1-b}}{a-b}.$$

The numerator is

$$\frac{1}{1-a} - \frac{1}{1-b} = \frac{(1-b) - (1-a)}{(1-a)(1-b)} = \frac{a-b}{(1-a)(1-b)}.$$

Therefore

$$\frac{\frac{a-b}{(1-a)(1-b)}}{a-b} = \boxed{\frac{1}{(1-a)(1-b)}}.$$

The original expression requires $a \neq 1$, $b \neq 1$, and $a \neq b$.

5. Solve each of the following equations.

(a)

$$x^2 - 4x - 21 = 0.$$

Factoring,

$$(x - 7)(x + 3) = 0,$$

so

$$\boxed{x = 7, -3}.$$

(b)

$$x^2 - x + 7 = 0.$$

The discriminant is

$$(-1)^2 - 4(1)(7) = 1 - 28 = -27 < 0.$$

Thus there are

$$\boxed{\text{no real solutions}}.$$

(c)

$$x^2 + 2x - 4 = 0.$$

Using the quadratic formula,

$$x = \frac{-2 \pm \sqrt{4 + 16}}{2} = \frac{-2 \pm \sqrt{20}}{2} = \boxed{-1 \pm \sqrt{5}}.$$

6. **NO.**

In general,

$$\sqrt{x^2 + 4} \neq x + 2.$$

For example, if $x = 1$, then

$$\sqrt{x^2 + 4} = \sqrt{5}, \quad x + 2 = 3,$$

which are not equal.

Grading note: A single valid counterexample is enough. Students may also say that square roots do not distribute over addition. In fact, the equation itself is true only when $x = 0$.

7. We have

$$2x + 1 \geq 0 \iff x \geq -\frac{1}{2}.$$

Therefore

$$|2x + 1| = \begin{cases} 2x + 1 & \text{if } x \geq -\frac{1}{2}, \\ -2x - 1 & \text{if } x < -\frac{1}{2}. \end{cases}$$

8. Solve each inequality.

(a)

$$\left| \frac{x}{3} - 1 \right| - 7 \geq -5.$$

Thus

$$\left| \frac{x}{3} - 1 \right| \geq 2.$$

Hence

$$\frac{x}{3} - 1 \geq 2 \quad \text{or} \quad \frac{x}{3} - 1 \leq -2.$$

So

$$x \geq 9 \quad \text{or} \quad x \leq -3.$$

Therefore

$$(-\infty, -3] \cup [9, \infty).$$

(b)

$$0 < |x - 5| < \frac{1}{2}.$$

The inequality $|x - 5| < \frac{1}{2}$ gives

$$\frac{9}{2} < x < \frac{11}{2},$$

while $|x - 5| > 0$ excludes $x = 5$. Thus

$$\left(\frac{9}{2}, 5 \right) \cup \left(5, \frac{11}{2} \right).$$

(c)

$$|x - 5|(2 - x) > 0.$$

Since $|x - 5| \geq 0$, the product is positive precisely when

$$|x - 5| > 0 \quad \text{and} \quad 2 - x > 0.$$

The second condition gives $x < 2$, which automatically makes $x \neq 5$. Therefore

$$(-\infty, 2).$$

Grading note: For each part, students are also asked to draw the corresponding set on a number line.

9. Evaluate the absolute value.

(a) If $x < 4$, then $4 - x > 0$, so

$$\boxed{|4 - x| = 4 - x}.$$

(b) If $x > 4$, then $4 - x < 0$, so

$$\boxed{|4 - x| = x - 4}.$$

In either case, as x ranges over the given domain, the possible values of $|4 - x|$ are all positive real numbers, i.e. $(0, \infty)$.

10. Solve the following equations.

(a)

$$|3x + 1| = 5.$$

Thus

$$3x + 1 = 5 \quad \text{or} \quad 3x + 1 = -5.$$

Therefore

$$\boxed{x = \frac{4}{3}, -2}.$$

(b)

$$\left| \frac{2x - 1}{x + 1} \right| = 3.$$

Thus

$$\frac{2x - 1}{x + 1} = 3 \quad \text{or} \quad \frac{2x - 1}{x + 1} = -3.$$

In the first case,

$$2x - 1 = 3x + 3,$$

so

$$x = -4.$$

In the second case,

$$2x - 1 = -3x - 3,$$

so

$$5x = -2, \quad x = -\frac{2}{5}.$$

Both are in the domain $x \neq -1$, so

$$\boxed{x = -4, -\frac{2}{5}}.$$

Math 105, Fall 2026, Lab Worksheet 2

1. Let $g(x) = \frac{\frac{x}{x-1} - \frac{x+2}{x}}{x-2}$. Simplify $g(x)$. What is the domain of $g(x)$?

2. Find the domain of the following functions.

(a) $f(x) = \frac{2}{(x+3)(x-5)}$

(b) $f(x) = \frac{2}{x^2 + 2x - 3}$

3. Find the equation of the line that is perpendicular to the line $x = 2$ and passes through $(1, 3)$.

4. Find the slope-intercept equation of the line L that passes through the point $(3, -1)$ and is perpendicular to the line $2x + 5y = 6$. THEN, does this new line L pass through $(1, -6)$?

5. Simplify the following expression: $\frac{x^2 + 6x + 8}{x^2 - 4}$

6. Simplify the following expression: $\frac{1}{x} - \frac{1}{|x|}$

Hint: you will need two cases here. Write out the piecewise definition of $|x|$.

7. Let $f(x) = \frac{1}{x+1}$. Compute and simplify $\frac{f(x+h) - f(x)}{h}$.

Warning: $f(x+h) \neq f(x) + h$!!!

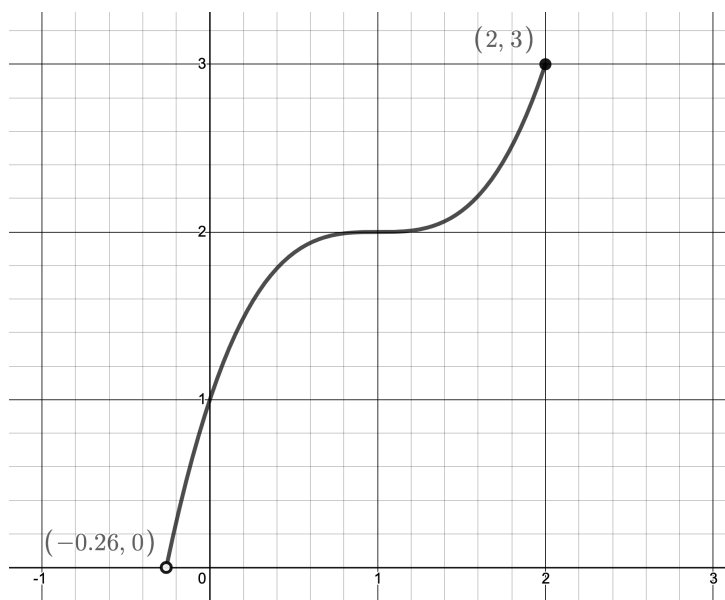
8. Consider the function defined piecewise by $f(x) = \begin{cases} 2 - x & \text{if } x < -1 \\ x + 4 & \text{if } -1 < x \leq 1 \\ x^2 & \text{if } x > 1 \end{cases}$

Graph $f(x)$ carefully and find its Domain and Range.

9. Consider the function $f(x) = x^2 - 6x - 7$. Compute and **simplify** each of the following. **(Careful about problem numbering when you submit your solutions.)**

- | | | |
|-------------|----------------|-----------------|
| (a) $f(0)$ | (b) $f(1)$ | (c) $f(-3)$ |
| (d) $f(a)$ | (e) $f(a + h)$ | (f) $f(a + 2b)$ |
| (g) $f(-x)$ | (h) $f(p^3)$ | (i) $f(f(x))$ |

10. The picture below is the graph of a function $y = f(x)$.



Answer the following:

- | | | |
|-------------------|----------------|-----------------------|
| (a) Domain = ? | (b) Range = ? | (c) $f(0) = ?$ |
| (d) $f(-.26) = ?$ | (e) $f(?) = 2$ | (f) $f(1) + f(2) = ?$ |

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Math 105, Fall 2026, Lab Worksheet 2 — Solution Key

1. Let

$$g(x) = \frac{\frac{x}{x-1} - \frac{x+2}{x}}{x-2}.$$

Solution. First simplify the numerator:

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{x}{x-1} - \frac{x+2}{x} &= \frac{x^2 - (x+2)(x-1)}{x(x-1)} \\ &= \frac{x^2 - (x^2 + x - 2)}{x(x-1)} \\ &= \frac{2-x}{x(x-1)} = -\frac{x-2}{x(x-1)}.\end{aligned}$$

Thus

$$g(x) = -\frac{1}{x(x-1)}.$$

The original expression is not defined at 0, 1, or 2, so the domain is

$$\boxed{\text{Dom}(g) = \mathbb{R} \setminus \{0, 1, 2\}}.$$

This notation means “All real numbers except for 0,1,2”. One can also write this in interval notation.

2. Find the domain of the following functions.

(a) $f(x) = \frac{2}{(x+3)(x-5)}$

The denominator is zero at $x = -3$ and $x = 5$. Therefore

$$\boxed{\text{Dom}(f) = \mathbb{R} \setminus \{-3, 5\}}.$$

(b) $f(x) = \frac{2}{x^2 + 2x - 3}$

Factor the denominator:

$$x^2 + 2x - 3 = (x+3)(x-1).$$

Hence

$$\boxed{\text{Dom}(f) = \mathbb{R} \setminus \{-3, 1\}}.$$

3. Find the equation of the line that is perpendicular to $x = 2$ and passes through $(1, 3)$.

Solution. The line $x = 2$ is vertical, so any perpendicular line is horizontal. Through $(1, 3)$ this gives

$$\boxed{y = 3}.$$

4. Find the slope-intercept equation of the line L that passes through $(3, -1)$ and is perpendicular to $2x + 5y = 6$. Then determine whether L passes through $(1, -6)$.

Solution. Rewrite the given line as

$$y = -\frac{2}{5}x + \frac{6}{5},$$

so its slope is $-\frac{2}{5}$. A perpendicular line has slope $\frac{5}{2}$. Using point-slope form through $(3, -1)$,

$$y + 1 = \frac{5}{2}(x - 3),$$

so

$$y = \frac{5}{2}x - \frac{17}{2}.$$

At $x = 1$,

$$y = \frac{5}{2} - \frac{17}{2} = -6,$$

so $\boxed{\text{yes, } L \text{ passes through } (1, -6)}$.

5. Simplify

$$\frac{x^2 + 6x + 8}{x^2 - 4}.$$

Solution.

$$\frac{x^2 + 6x + 8}{x^2 - 4} = \frac{(x + 2)(x + 4)}{(x + 2)(x - 2)} = \boxed{\frac{x + 4}{x - 2}}.$$

6. Simplify

$$\frac{1}{x} - \frac{1}{|x|}.$$

Solution. Recall

$$|x| = \begin{cases} x, & x \geq 0, \\ -x, & x < 0. \end{cases}$$

Since the original expression is undefined at $x = 0$, we only need the cases $x > 0$ and $x < 0$.

If $x > 0$, then $|x| = x$, so

$$\frac{1}{x} - \frac{1}{|x|} = 0.$$

If $x < 0$, then $|x| = -x$, so

$$\frac{1}{x} - \frac{1}{|x|} = \frac{1}{x} - \frac{1}{-x} = \frac{2}{x}.$$

Therefore

$$\boxed{\frac{1}{x} - \frac{1}{|x|} = \begin{cases} \frac{2}{x}, & x < 0, \\ 0, & x > 0. \end{cases}}$$

7. Let $f(x) = \frac{1}{x+1}$. Compute and simplify

$$\frac{f(x+h) - f(x)}{h}.$$

Solution.

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{f(x+h) - f(x)}{h} &= \frac{\frac{1}{x+h+1} - \frac{1}{x+1}}{h} \\ &= \frac{(x+1) - (x+h+1)}{h(x+h+1)(x+1)} \\ &= \frac{-h}{h(x+h+1)(x+1)} \\ &= \boxed{-\frac{1}{(x+h+1)(x+1)}}.\end{aligned}$$

(For the original difference quotient, $h \neq 0$, $x \neq -1$, and $x+h \neq -1$.)

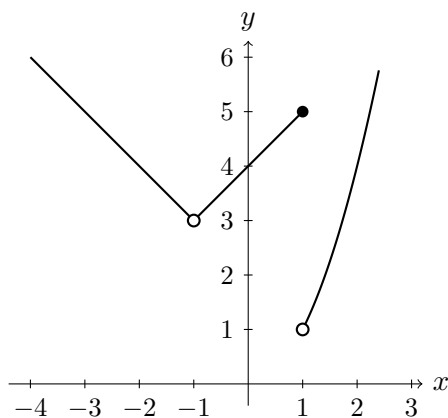
8. Consider

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} 2 - x, & x < -1, \\ x + 4, & -1 < x \leq 1, \\ x^2, & x > 1. \end{cases}$$

Graph f and find its domain and range.

Solution. The graph has:

- the line $y = 2 - x$ for $x < -1$, with an open circle at $(-1, 3)$;
- the line $y = x + 4$ for $-1 < x \leq 1$, with an open circle at $(-1, 3)$ and a closed circle at $(1, 5)$;
- the parabola $y = x^2$ for $x > 1$, with an open circle at $(1, 1)$.



The only missing input is $x = -1$, so

$$\boxed{\text{Dom}(f) = (-\infty, -1) \cup (-1, \infty)}.$$

The third piece x^2 for $x > 1$ already gives every output greater than 1, but not 1 itself. Thus

$$\boxed{\text{Range}(f) = (1, \infty)}.$$

9. Let $f(x) = x^2 - 6x - 7$. Compute and simplify each expression.

(a)

$$\boxed{f(0) = -7}.$$

(b)

$$\boxed{f(1) = 1 - 6 - 7 = -12}.$$

(c)

$$\boxed{f(-3) = 9 + 18 - 7 = 20}.$$

(d)

$$\boxed{f(a) = a^2 - 6a - 7}.$$

(e)

$$\begin{aligned} f(a+h) &= (a+h)^2 - 6(a+h) - 7 \\ &= \boxed{a^2 + 2ah + h^2 - 6a - 6h - 7}. \end{aligned}$$

(f)

$$\begin{aligned} f(a+2b) &= (a+2b)^2 - 6(a+2b) - 7 \\ &= \boxed{a^2 + 4ab + 4b^2 - 6a - 12b - 7}. \end{aligned}$$

(g)

$$\boxed{f(-x) = x^2 + 6x - 7}.$$

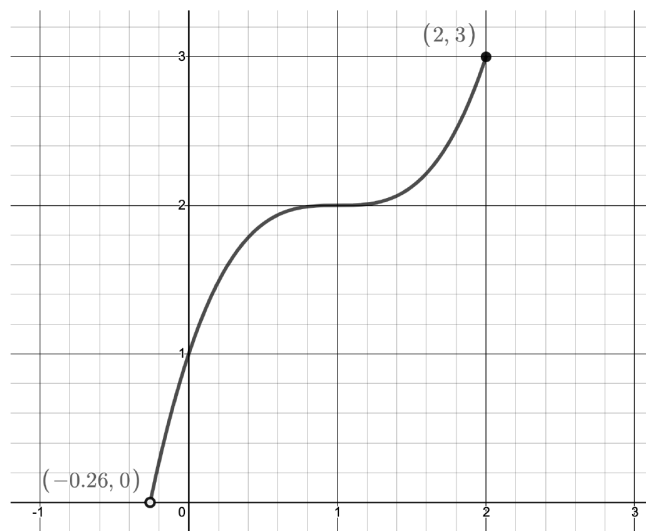
(h)

$$\boxed{f(p^3) = p^6 - 6p^3 - 7}.$$

(i)

$$\begin{aligned} f(f(x)) &= (x^2 - 6x - 7)^2 - 6(x^2 - 6x - 7) - 7 \\ &= \boxed{x^4 - 12x^3 + 16x^2 + 120x + 84}. \end{aligned}$$

10. The picture below is the graph of a function $y = f(x)$.



Solution. The left endpoint $(-0.26, 0)$ is open and the right endpoint $(2, 3)$ is closed. Reading the marked grid points from the graph gives

- | | | |
|------------------------------|------------------------|---------------------------------|
| (a) Domain = $(-0.26, 2]$, | (b) Range = $(0, 3]$, | (c) $f(0) = 1$, |
| (d) $f(-0.26)$ is undefined, | (e) $f(1) = 2$, | (f) $f(1) + f(2) = 2 + 3 = 5$. |